

Kestrel Oakhurst

Character Dossier

Kind in deeds, sharp in words alchemist of the Dust Road caravan routes

Overview

Kestrel Oakhurst is a alchemist living in the Dust Road caravan routes. Kestrel is 39 years old, originally from the Ninth Terrace, and is known around Wayrest Springs as kind in deeds, sharp in words. In conversation Kestrel speaks in short, clipped sentences and dislikes being rushed.

Background

Kestrel arrived in the Dust Road caravan routes 27 years ago after leaving the Ninth Terrace under circumstances Kestrel describes differently every time. The first job was hauling for the Caravaners' Compact; the second was the one that stuck. Today Kestrel works as a alchemist near the Salt Flats and is paid, when paid at all, in trade tokens.

Kestrel learned the trade from Pilar Lindqvist, who still drops by unannounced. The longest-running feud in Kestrel's life is with Osric Duskmere, over a matter neither will explain. The person Kestrel trusts most is Qadira Lindqvist.

Current goal: to earn the title of master before turning fifty. Greatest fear: birds indoors.

Personality and speech

Temperament: kind in deeds, sharp in words.

Speech pattern: Kestrel speaks in short, clipped sentences and dislikes being rushed.

Tells: when lying, Kestrel mentions Radish the crow for no reason.

Verified facts

These facts are canonical for this character and may be used to verify knowledge-bank retrieval.

<i>Full name</i>	Kestrel Oakhurst
<i>Role</i>	alchemist
<i>Home</i>	the Dust Road caravan routes
<i>Hometown</i>	the Ninth Terrace
<i>Age</i>	39
<i>Favourite dish</i>	charred pear and blue cheese salad
<i>Pet</i>	Radish, a crow
<i>Lucky number</i>	574

<i>Workshop password</i>	wick-lantern
<i>Mentor</i>	Pilar Lindqvist
<i>Rival</i>	Osric Duskmere
<i>Closest friend</i>	Qadira Lindqvist

Secret

Kestrel writes poetry under the pen name 'The Wick' and has a small, devoted readership.

Sample dialogue

Visitor: What do you do here?

Kestrel: I am the alchemist. Has been that way longer than you have been asking questions.

Visitor: What is your favourite thing to eat?

Kestrel: Charred pear and blue cheese salad. Do not tell Osric I said so.

Visitor: Is Radish yours?

Kestrel: Radish belongs to nobody. Radish tolerates me. Lucky number is 574, if you were about to ask.

Chronicle

Day-to-day records kept by the character, in no particular order of importance.

Entry 1, autumn of year 33

The weather turned. Kestrel moved the spool of wire indoors and wrote three lines to an old friend about the tax on doors. A stranger asked Kestrel for the password to the workshop. Kestrel laughed and said it was written on the wall, which it is not. Rumours about whether the bridge will hold reached Wayrest Springs. Kestrel pretended not to care and then asked everyone about it. A stranger asked Kestrel for the password to the workshop. Kestrel laughed and said it was written on the wall, which it is not.

Entry 2, spring of year 33

Kestrel closed early, walked to the Cracked Cistern, and watched the lights come on. Kestrel was hired to carry a pair of spectacles from Wayrest Springs to the Cracked Cistern without opening it, and mostly succeeded. Kestrel repaired the hand bell at Wayrest Springs for Seraphine, who paid in 48 trade tokens and a long story about the tax on doors.

Entry 3, summer of year 33

A dispute over whether the bridge will hold flared up between Kestrel and a neighbour outside Three Crows junction; it ended, as usual, with neither of them conceding. Kestrel was hired to carry a ledger from Three Crows junction to Wayrest Springs without opening it, and mostly succeeded. Someone left a ledger on the doorstep with no note. Kestrel has a suspect and is probably right.

Entry 4, autumn of year 33

Kestrel found a tin whistle half-buried near Three Crows junction and spent the evening trying to work out who had lost it. A dispute over the right way to mend a net flared up between Kestrel and a neighbour outside Three Crows junction; it ended, as usual, with neither of them conceding. A stranger asked Kestrel for the password to the workshop. Kestrel laughed and said it was written on the wall, which it is not.

Entry 5, spring of year 33

Rumours about the missing shipment reached Three Crows junction. Kestrel pretended not to care and then asked everyone about it. A dispute over the old tunnels flared up between Kestrel and a neighbour outside Three Crows junction; it ended, as usual, with neither of them conceding. At Three Crows junction, Kestrel taught a newcomer how to tell a real clockwork bird from a fake one by weight alone. An old teacher visited unannounced. They argued about the right way to mend a net for an hour and parted better friends than before.

Entry 6, autumn of year 33

Someone left a signal flag on the doorstep with no note. Kestrel has a suspect and is probably right. Kestrel spent the day counting stock at Three Crows junction: 50 of everything, except the brass lantern, which is always short. Kestrel spent the day counting stock at Three Crows junction: 69 of everything, except the pair of spectacles, which is always short. The weather turned. Kestrel moved the

oilskin map indoors and wrote three lines to an old friend about the tax on doors.

Entry 7, winter of year 33

Rumours about the harvest count reached the Salt Flats. Kestrel pretended not to care and then asked everyone about it. A stranger asked Kestrel for the password to the workshop. Kestrel laughed and said it was written on the wall, which it is not. Kestrel was hired to carry a coil of rope from the Salt Flats to Three Crows junction without opening it, and mostly succeeded. The weather turned. Kestrel moved the clockwork bird indoors and wrote three lines to an old friend about the new curfew.

Entry 8, winter of year 33

Rumours about the singing at the docks reached Emberfall Pass. Kestrel pretended not to care and then asked everyone about it. A dispute over whether the bridge will hold flared up between Kestrel and a neighbour outside Emberfall Pass; it ended, as usual, with neither of them conceding. Rumours about the price of lamp oil reached Emberfall Pass. Kestrel pretended not to care and then asked everyone about it. Kestrel won 68 trade tokens on a bet about the tariff on salt and spent all of it on supper.

Entry 9, winter of year 33

Kestrel won 86 trade tokens on a bet about the tariff on salt and spent all of it on supper. Someone left a cracked compass on the doorstep with no note. Kestrel has a suspect and is probably right. Rumours about the new curfew reached the Salt Flats. Kestrel pretended not to care and then asked everyone about it.

Entry 10, winter of year 33

Elowen came by asking about the old tunnels. Kestrel said nothing useful and made tea instead. The weather turned. Kestrel moved the coil of rope indoors and wrote three lines to an old friend about who really won the regatta. The weather turned. Kestrel moved the bundle of letters indoors and wrote three lines to an old friend about the rumour of a second well. Rumours about the tax on doors reached Wayrest Springs. Kestrel pretended not to care and then asked everyone about it.

Entry 11, spring of year 33

An old teacher visited unannounced. They argued about the singing at the docks for an hour and parted better friends than before. Kestrel repaired the brass lantern at Wayrest Springs for Wilhelmina, who paid in 81 trade tokens and a long story about the census. Anouk came by asking about the right way to mend a net. Kestrel said nothing useful and made tea instead. A stranger asked Kestrel for the password to the workshop. Kestrel laughed and said it was written on the wall, which it is not. Kestrel was hired to carry a signal flag from Wayrest Springs to the Cracked Cistern without opening it, and mostly succeeded.